



MONTHLY UPDATE

National statistics: monthly update, August 2026

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BOTSWANA · CAMEROON · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · COMOROS · CONGO · DR CONGO · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · GABON · GHANA · LESOTHO · LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MALI · MAURITANIA · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGERIA · SEYCHELLES · SOUTH AFRICA · UGANDA · ZIMBABWE

Botswana

The statistics office and the national university [launched a second Statistics Development Strategy for 2026 to 2030 on 12 August](#), framed as a roadmap to an agile and responsive statistical system and aligned to the twelfth national development plan. No budget, delivery milestone or indicator set is published with it.

Cameroon

The fourth population and agriculture census is still in the field: a [complementary enumeration period runs from 1 August to 15 September to reach households, persons and agricultural holdings missed by the 29 May close](#). Enumeration ran with [32,059 agents at a budget of FCFA 13.28bn against FCFA 64bn initially projected](#), and no results are published. It is the first census in over twenty years, with population and agriculture merged into one questionnaire.

Central African Republic

The statistics institute [deployed enumerator teams nationwide on 20 July, opening six months of collection across about 7,000 households in three two-month waves, entirely by tablet](#), with a public commitment to statistical secrecy and aggregates only. The field period ends around January 2027; no results date is stated and no prior harmonised survey is held.

Two further statistical operations surfaced in August, both financed by the World Bank. The [third data-cleaning phase of the fourth population and housing census was presented on 6 August](#), a step toward definitive results from the country's first digital census; cleaning has been running since May 2026, under the HISWACA-SOP2 project with UNFPA as technical partner. No enumeration total or publication date is stated.

The institute also [released the aide-mémoire on rebasing the national accounts to 2019 under SCN 2008](#), moving off a 2005 base built on SCN 1993 and drawing on the 2021 agriculture and household living-conditions surveys to widen coverage of agriculture, household consumption, self-build, imputed rent and informal activity. The peer review it records was held in February 2023; what is new is its publication, and the record states no rebased GDP level.

Comoros

The statistics institute ran a [sensitisation campaign across the archipelago's governors, prefects, mayors and village chiefs and held a five-day donor-funded training-of-trainers workshop on survey methodology, questionnaire design and electronic data-collection tools](#), ahead of the annual agricultural survey's rollout. It follows the second general agricultural census, whose results were published in April, and no first survey round or results date is on record. The source dates the workshop inconsistently with its own reference to the previous week, so only the campaign's dates are internally reliable.

The census apparatus moved alongside it: [the fifth population and housing census finalised its methodological and digital instruments at a retreat from 10 to 17 August](#). No enumeration date is published.

Congo

The quarterly labour-market and informal-sector survey moved from preparation into regional alignment: a [harmonisation workshop opened on 19 August, running to 27 August, on aligning the region's labour statistics with international standards](#). Four series of indicators a year are planned, a first for the country, and no fieldwork date, sample or budget is stated.

DR Congo

The planning minister [announced recruitment of mapping agents and fixed general enumeration for July 2027](#), which would be the country's first census since 1984. No budget line, financing source, implementing contract or cartography completion figure is held. Separately a [digital sector barometer was announced after a working session on 6 August](#) to give government figures on firms' activity, turnover, growth and job creation — proposed by the industry body rather than imposed by the state, with no operator, methodology or first-issue date stated.

Equatorial Guinea

INEGE opened a three-day validation workshop on 27 July at the Ministry of Finance, Budgets and National Planning on the project document, resource-mobilisation advocacy strategy and social-communication strategy for the [fifth population census and the first agricultural census](#), with UNFPA and FAO technical support and around fifty representatives of ministries, the National Assembly, the UN system, the AfDB, the World Bank, WHO and CEMAC. Decree 25/2025 of 3 March 2025 authorises both operations; the last population census was in 2015.

Census preparation was validated a second time in four weeks without an enumeration date being set. The scientific committee [validated the project document, the resource-mobilisation strategy and the communication strategy for the fifth population and housing census and the first agricultural census](#), reading into the record the 2025 decree ordering both operations and the resolution that created the committees. The project document is stated to fix objectives, methodology, timetable and the agricultural sample size; none of it is published, and neither is a date on which anyone will be counted.

The fifth interministerial council of the year [adopted a National Quality Assurance Framework for official statistics on 25 August, a standardised protocol for the collection, processing and dissemination of socio-economic data presented as aligning national method with international standards](#); the framework text is not published.

Gabon

On 21 July an interministerial committee fixed the terms of a second census of economically weak Gabonese, with preparation through July and August and fieldwork from September 2026, drawing on the population census and health-insurance records; its stated purpose is that the existing social file is not reliable enough to target protection ([terms](#)).

Ghana

The statistical service [published the third wave of its six-monthly governance panel on 6 August](#), run across all sixteen regions, with the Government Statistician putting its findings to digital remedies — digitising public services and publishing official fees among them. The report text is not held. Separately the finance minister [asked the service to develop a methodology for quarterly employment statistics](#); none is published and no timetable is set.

Lesotho

The Bureau of Statistics [lists the strategy for 2022/23 to 2026/27 alongside the 2001 Act as its current framework](#). The strategy runs out in the coming financial year and no successor is on the record.

Libya

On 5 August the Central Bank put [electronic transactions at LD 643 billion for the first seven months of 2026](#), and forecast that they would exceed LD 1 trillion by the year's end.

Madagascar

The statistics institute runs a [registration-gated platform advertising household surveys for 2020 to 2022, an enterprise survey and census microdata](#). The datasets sit behind account registration and were not retrieved, so no dataset documentation, sample size, licence or reuse terms is established beyond the landing page.

Malawi

The statistical office and the communications regulator [put a Fourth National ICT Survey into the field from August to October across all districts, including the refugee camp at Dzaleka](#), covering mobile and computer ownership, internet access, digital financial services, e-commerce and cybersecurity awareness. No publication date for the results is stated, which is the part that decides whether it informs anything.

Mali

The statistics institute runs a [microdata archive under its own domain holding 107 studies](#), led by the 2022 census and near-annual agricultural surveys since 1996/1997. It is a first-party statistical archive rather than a whole-of-government open-data portal, and the base holds nothing of the latter kind.

Mauritania

The fifth general population and housing census [presented its final regional results from 3 August](#). No methodology note, response rate or dissemination calendar accompanies the presentation, so what the base holds is that the results exist rather than what they say.

Mozambique

The statistics institute opened enumerator training on 27 July for a census pilot running 1-15 August, testing procedures for a 2027 census it states will be the first run entirely in digital format ([training account](#)).

The digital system intended for the 2027 census [failed in testing](#), and the statistics institute's president announced on 21 August 2026 that it is to be improved. That is a delivery risk stated by the issuing institute itself; no revised specification, retest date or fallback accompanies it.

Namibia

The statistics agency is publishing both its data and, unusually, an account of its own machinery. Its [data portals and microdata catalogue are live, neither page carrying its own publication date](#); the [second-quarter producer price index bulletin is held in full](#); and the agency [disclosed in that bulletin that it has completed a migration of the index's compilation system](#). Disclosing a system change inside the statistical release it affects is the practice that lets a reader judge a break in series; no back-series revision or comparability note is published with it.

Nigeria

An inclusive-data initiative brought the national statistics office into a five-country programme.

A state put a household survey at the centre of its budgeting. Katsina [launched six planning documents on 28 August, among them a General Household Survey Report and a State Statistical Yearbook covering poverty, employment, livelihoods, agriculture, education, healthcare, housing, water, sanitation and access to basic services across its 34 local government areas](#), the budget commissioner directing agencies to align their programmes to the new frameworks.

Seychelles

The statistical work of the window is climate data with a funding line behind it. Seychelles [launched its national implementation of a nine-country African island-states resilience programme, backed by a US\\$4.943 million readiness grant, whose data leg is a standardised approach to institutional readiness, multi-hazard risk assessment and information systems](#), the stated purpose being to build pipelines of climate-resilient projects able to reach international finance. The grant figure covers all nine countries; the national share is not published, so the base can date the launch and not size it.

South Africa

A statistical series came back after five years. Statistics South Africa [restored its monthly insolvencies series, interrupted since the 2021 cyber incident at the Department of Justice cut off the administrative supply, with a first release on 21 July covering June 2026 and a time series back to January 2023](#). It is the clearest cost of a security failure this ledger holds: an official series lost because another department's systems went down, and recovered only now.

The office also published [a frame update for the continuous population survey and household survey programme redesign](#), the instrument intended to carry population statistics between censuses. No first release is named with it.

Uganda

The statistics bureau [commissioned 80 field data collectors on 4 August](#) for the ninth national household survey, deployed in 16 language-based teams after fifteen days' training, for twelve months of collection. No sample size, budget, funder or publication date was stated.

Zimbabwe

The 2025 household survey, released on 20 July, reported household internet access at 75.5% against 50.1% in 2020, mobile handset ownership at 96.4%, and household computer ownership down to 11.2% from 14.2%, at 21.2% urban against 4.7% rural ([survey account](#)).

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